

Robert Murray M'Cheyne – 1813-1843 **He died at the young age of 30** during a typhus epidemic! Pastor, Evangelist. It is said of him that **he 'was widely regarded as one of the most saintly and able young ministers of his day.'** (BTT) He was saved by reading David Dickson's (see his earlier mention), *Sum of Saving Knowledge*. He became a capable and beloved preacher and man of God. Of whom Iain Murray remarked, 'he had a remarkable influence in his lifetime'). Writings: ***Bible Reading Plan***, many, many others. One of his famous quotes – "Am I redeeming the time."

John Murray – 1898-1975 – long time Professor at Princeton, then Westminster, with notables such as Machen and VanTil, following on the heels of A.A. and Charles Hodge and B.B. Warfield. BTT describes him as **'a careful scholar, an eloquent lecturer, a moving preacher, and the author of many outstanding articles and books. Murray's driving passions were to declare Christ's Word, advance His cause, and bless His people.'**

Scottish Divines – a primer for Danny

Some time ago, I began to notice a common thread with some of my favorite commentaries – many of them were written by Scottish Presbyterians. They also all seemed to be exceptionally godly men, with an exceedingly high view of God's Word. About a year ago, I began to compile biographical notes on these men. Then, in God's providence, you called to invite us on the Reformation tour. I was thrilled (still am) that I get to come and walk where these dear brothers walked.

During these two weeks, we will hear about the spiritual giants – **John Knox, Patrick Henry, John Rogers, Thomas Cromwell, John Bunyan & Isaac Watts** – two of my heroes of the faith, and **Charles Spurgeon** (everyone's favorite). But there is another list of godly men – the kind of men that early American Pastor, Samuel Davies, referred to as 'the venerable dead.' These were premier exegetes who, though less well-known, are most highly regarded by many more than just this one pastor. These are the additional men about whom I will be thinking as we trek about ...

David Dickson – 1583-1663 – Pastor He was, as Murray captures it, **'the instrument in the hand of God of numerous conversions.'** Professor (he played a considerable part in establishing vital, orthodox Christianity throughout the land.), Theologian, Non-Conformist. Commentaries: Hebrews, Paul's Epistles, Matthew, Psalms, ***Truth's Victory over Error: Commentary of the Westminster Confession, Therapeutica Sacra*** – manual of spiritual counsel, etc.

Robert Haldane – 1764-1842 – very remarkable evangelist! He served in the navy in the war with France and returned home to his family estate – the *Airthrey Castle*, but soon **dedicated his life and wealth to evangelistic efforts** – at home and in India and Africa. In time, **he sold his family's estate to fund missionary work and establishment of Churches**. Writings: **He only wrote one commentary, an excellent commentary on Romans – the result of many years of study**, and *Evidences and Authority of Divine Revelation*.

John Brown (of Whitburn) – 1784-1858 (of special note to me personally because he died exactly 100 years before I was born) – Pastor – he was ...

'singularly devoted to one aim, the exposition and preaching of the Word of God ... he viewed commenting on the Scriptures as his highest privilege and duty ... he was profoundly disturbed at the all too common custom of ministers preaching a truth which was nevertheless not the truth of the text upon which they based their sermon ... he labored quietly and studiously at Biggar, a small town ... amidst the temptations of popularity, the struggles of controversy, and the responsibilities of leadership in his denomination – John Brown remained a spiritual Christian.' (BTT)

Spurgeon called him, **'a modern day Puritan.'** His biographer said of him that **'he not only employed his entire powers in the study of the Scriptures,**

but resigned his whole being to the empire of the Word of God.' Iain Murray identifies him as 'one of the greatest Scottish exegetes of the 19th century.' I'd add about 20 more centuries to that. Writings: Excellent commentary on **Hebrews, Galatians**, *Christian Pastor's Manual*.

Patrick Fairbairn – 1805-1874 – Pastor Scholar, Theologian. **'He combined his extensive experience of pastoral work with many years of well-regulated and exacting study of Scripture and the disciplines ancillary to its interpretation.'** (BTT) . Writings: *Jonah, Ezekiel, Pastoral Epistles, Interpretation of Prophecy*.

John Eadie – 1810-1876 – Pastor, Professor. **He pastored his Church in Glasgow for 28 years, where his influence was felt throughout the region.** Then was called to Kelvin, which Church he pastored for 13 more years (God *does*, at times, relocate His servants). One historian noted of him,

... there never was a harder worker than the general divine, who yet bore no visible trace of the toil under the burden of which he sank before his time. He stood apart from the heats of controversy and was loved and trusted by men of every creed. His fellow-citizens were proud of him as one whose name was known and honored in the quiet retreats of learning ...

Writings: Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, *History of the English Bible*.